

MY FIRST SIEM Report

2025/12/06

Scenario

You are the Level 1 Analyst of your organization's SOC team. You receive an alert that a port scanning activity has been observed on one of the hosts in the network. You have access to the SIEM solution, where you can see all the associated logs for this alert. You are tasked to view the logs individually and answer the question to the 5 Ws given below.

STEP 1: WHAT

What: Activity that triggered the alert?

Port Scan

✓ Correct Answer

The goal was to find the reason behind the alert.

I found that it was an internal operation which was intended to be a port scan.

STEP 2: WHEN

When: Time of the activity?

June 12, 2024 17:24

✓ Correct Answer

The goal was to find the time of the activity on the Alerts page.

The time of the activity was indicated on the page.

STEP 3: WHERE

Where: Destination host IP?

10.0.0.3

✓ Correct Answer

The goal was to find the destination host IP.

I found it when I clicked to investigate the SIEM

Time	Log Type	Source Range	Source IP	Destination IP	Source Port	Destination Port
June 12, 2024 17:24	Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	443
June 12, 2024 17:24	Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	53
June 12, 2024 17:24	Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	22
June 12, 2024 17:24	Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	22

STEP 4: WHO

Who: Source host name?

Nessus

✓ Correct Answer

The goal was to find the source host name in the SIEM.

Log Type	Source Range	Source IP	Destination IP	Source Port	Destination Port	Source Host Name	Destination Host Name
Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	443	NESSUS	JOE PC
Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	53	NESSUS	JOE PC
Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	22	NESSUS	JOE PC
Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	22	NESSUS	JOE PC
Traffic	Private	10.0.0.8	10.0.0.3	56927	22	NESSUS	JOE PC

I identified the source host name as NESSUS.

STEP 5: WHY

Why: Reason for the activity? Intended/Malicious

Intended

✓ Correct Answer

The goal was to find the reason behind the activity.

After investigating, what do you think the activity was?

Option A: True Positive (it was an actual incident)

Option B: False Positive (it was not an incident)

The activity was intended as it was detailed in the task that the reason behind this alert was the SOC team performing a port scan.

Success!

As mentioned in the task, the vulnerability assessment team notified the SOC team that they were running a port scan activity inside the network from the host: 10.0.0.8

[Go To Alerts Dashboard](#)

Conclusion

This investigation demonstrated a full SIEM analysis workflow by identifying the **what, when, where, who, and why** behind the generated alert. Through reviewing the SIEM alerts page and investigating the event details, I discovered that the activity was an intentional **internal port scan** performed by the SOC team. The alert originated from the host named **NESSUS**, which acted as the source of the scan, and the destination IP was located through the SIEM investigation panel. The event timestamp confirmed when the activity occurred, allowing accurate correlation of all relevant data.

Overall, this exercise strengthened my understanding of SIEM navigation, alert analysis, and the importance of verifying whether unusual activity is malicious or part of authorized security operations.